are positive that they will be able to take concrete steps in areas like capacity-building, identification of funding gaps, enhancement of employment opportunities, achievement of SDG targets and the growth of an inclusive ecosystem.

Q. Geopolitical headwinds, particularly the Russia-Ukraine war, make the task of forging global consensus complicated. We are seeing different countries try to find a way of forging peace between Russia and Ukraine. As G20 president, do you have a plan which you think may help in finding a way out of the Russia-Ukraine war?

You should assess whether it is desirable to link G20 or our G20 presidency with this issue. Why did it occur to you to ask about just this issue as if there is only one problem in the world? Why did it not occur to you that there are problems in other parts of the world like in Syria, in some countries in Africa, in East Asia, in Latin America? There are international organisations like the United Nations that are focusing on these issues. My focus is that we will steer our G20 presidency to build common positions on developmental issues that are of importance to the Global South.

Q. You advocated vigorously for the African Union to be granted membership of the G20. What role do you see the African Union playing in the G20 and in shaping the new emerging world order?

In October 2015, we had held a big India-Africa Summit in New Delhi. It was a massive effort where leaders from 54 countries of the African continent had come to India. I feel deeply for the countries of the Global South. It is my firm belief that we need to give importance to the developing world if we have to make progress on the global development agenda. If we give them their rightful place, listen to them, understand their priorities, they have the capacity and capability to contribute to the global good.

When I was the chief minister of Gujarat, I had, for the first time, hosted the Summit of the Africa Development Bank in Ahmedabad. It was also the first time they had held their meeting outside Africa. It was a great success. This time, we decided to keep '*Vasudhaiva kutumbakam* (The world is our family)' as the motto of our G20 presidency. It is based on our fundamental belief and ethos. If we do not include developing countries, how can we realise *vasudhaiva kutumbakam*? How can there be One Earth, One Family, One Future? That is why, after taking over the presidency of G20, the first event that I held was the Voice of Global South Summit in January this year. After having listened to them, understanding their priorities and concerns, we set the agenda for our G20 presidency. We have brought the priorities of the Global South onto the agenda of the G20, and we have made progress. It is in this spirit that I have taken the initiative to make the African Union a permanent member of G20 during our presidency. I am confident that we will receive support to realise the same. This will make G20 more representative and give greater voice to the Global South.

A big threat to the world order emerges when countries feel that their views, concerns and issues are not taken into consideration in the decision-making process. It has been our conviction that without the voice and participation of the developing world, sustainable solutions to global challenges cannot be found. Africa, in particular, has not been given its due recognition and place when it comes to institutions of global governance. India and Africa enjoy a very special relationship, and India has been a steadfast advocate of a greater role for Africa in global affairs.

During our presidency of the G20, we have taken the initiative to seek a permanent seat for the African Union in the G20, and we believe that our proposal will enjoy the support of other G20 members. We believe that this step will empower the African continent and enable it to better articulate their concerns and perspectives on the global stage, and play an important role in shaping the world order. ■



A NEW DAWN PM Modi with Cyril Ramaphosa, the president of South Africa, in Johannesburg, Aug. 23

"THE DEVELOPED AND THE DEVELOPING COUNTRIES WILL COME TOGETHER FOR THE FIRST TIME AND FIND SOLUTIONS TO GLOBAL PROBLEMS. WE HAVE LAID THE FOUNDATION FOR INCLUSIVITY BY INVITING THE AFRICAN UNION"